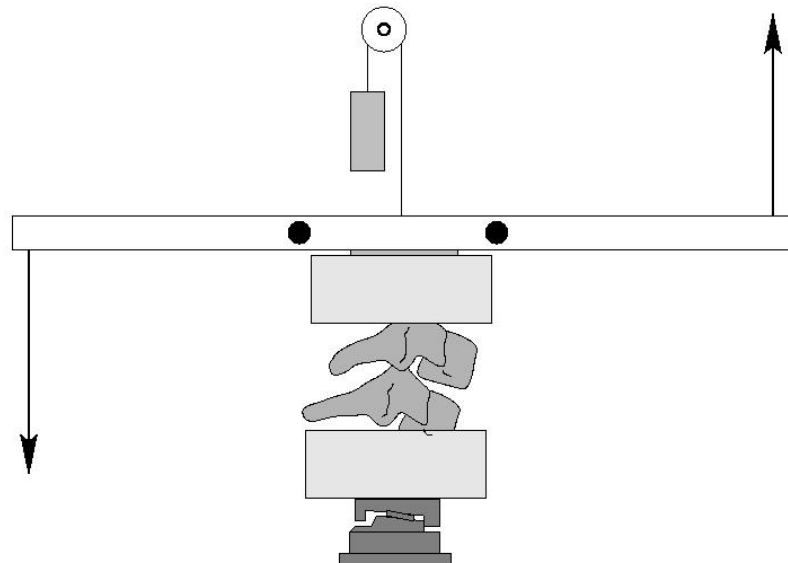

Bending Responses Of The Human Cervical Spine

Failure Test Report

Test Reference: B04F34FAIL

Test Date: 3/31/98

Submission Date: 8/16/00



Duke University, Department of Biomedical Engineering
NHTSA Cooperative Agreement No. *DTNH22-94-Y-07133*
Principal Investigators:

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Study Objective: The objective of this study is to provide data on the responses of the human cervical spine to pure bending. The experimental protocol consists of two tests: a flexibility test and a failure test. The flexibility test is designed to quantify the static response of motion segments to flexion and extension moments. The failure test is designed to quantify the bending tolerance of motion segments. See the Methods Section for more details on the experimental protocol.

Test Objective: Flexion Failure Test

Test Reference: B04F34FAIL

Motion Segment: C3 - C4

Specimen ID: B04F

Specimen Description

Sex: Female

Age: 46 years

Weight: (N)

Height: (cm)

Head Length: (cm)

Head Height: (cm)

Comments:

Results:

Sign Conventions: Compliant with SAE J211/1 March 1995

Load Cell	Measure	Manipulation	Polarity
GSE 6607 Upper Neck Load Cell	Fx	Head Rearward	+
	Fy	Head Leftward	+
	Fz	Head Upward	+
	Mx	Left Ear to Left Shoulder	+
	My	Chin to Sternum	+

Results (cont.):

Data Channels

Curve	Measurement	Location	Axis	Unit	Min	Max	Comments
1	Load Cell	NEKL	XL	NWT	-45.9	0.0	NO COMMENTS
2	Load Cell	NEKL	ZL	NWT	-58.2	385.0	NO COMMENTS
3	Load Cell	NEKL	YL	NWM	-0.2	28.9	NO COMMENTS
4	Load Cell	NEKL	YL	NWT	-46.3	202.0	NO COMMENTS
5	Load Cell	NEKL	XL	NWM	-0.3	4.2	NO COMMENTS
6	Computed	NEKL	YL	NWM	-0.2	17.8	MOMENT-ANGLE

All channels have had small biases removed. The biases were recorded when the channels were zeroed during the establishment of the reference position. See the Appendix for more details.

Data:

Sampling Frequency: **1000 (hz)**
Camera Frame Rate: **125 (fps)**
Initial Frame: **F100.gif**
Prefilter Frequency: **1000 (hz)**

Number of Samples: **509**
Angle at Failure: **18.50 degrees**
Moment at Failure: **9.00 N-m**

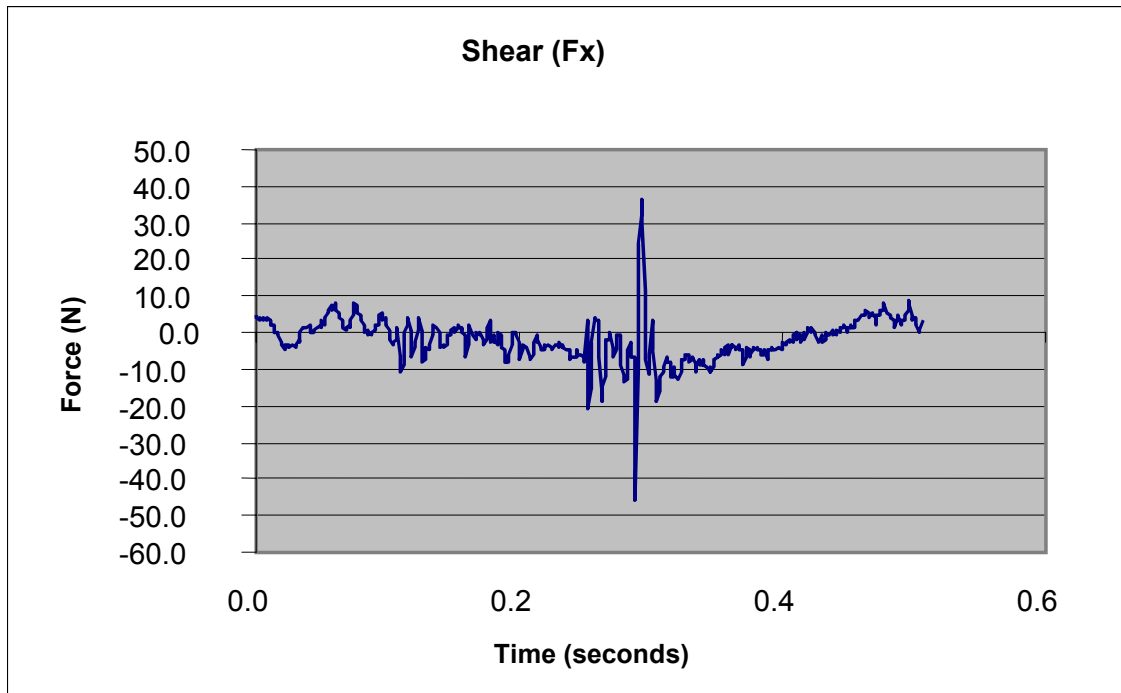
The digital images are of the failure test, with the first frame corresponding to time 0 of the instrument data. All the angles are computed relative to the specimen Reference Image. The Reference Image is included with the flexibility test report for this specimen.

Injury Summary: All ligaments were completely disrupted.

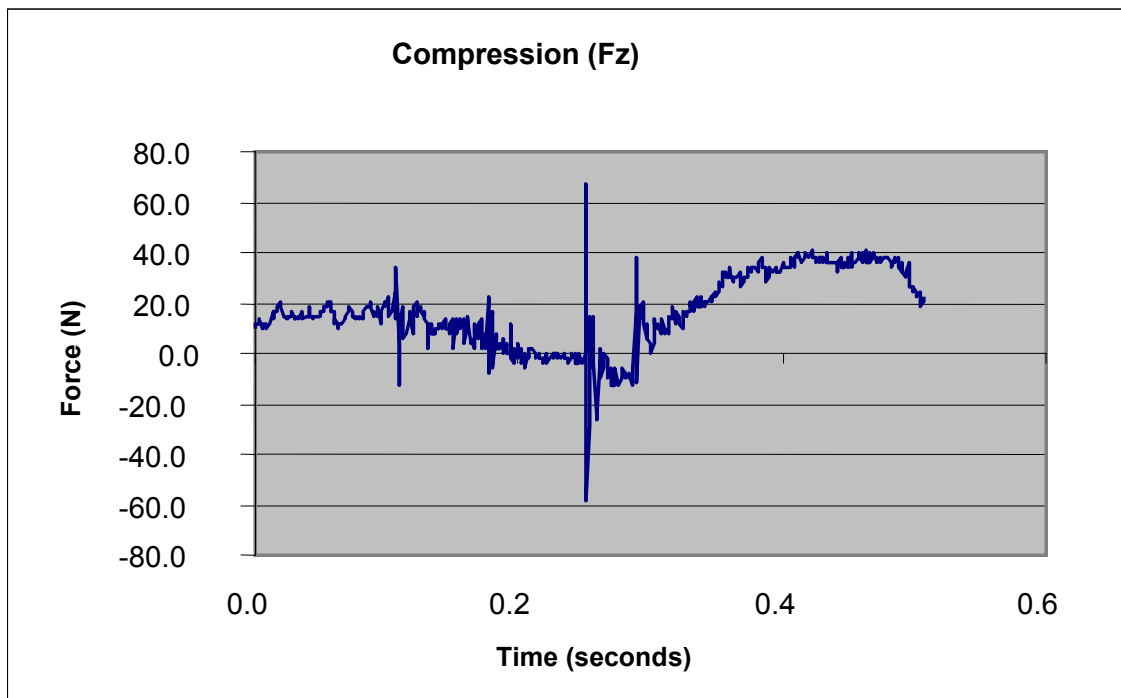
Comments:

Raw Instrument Data

B04F34FAIL.1

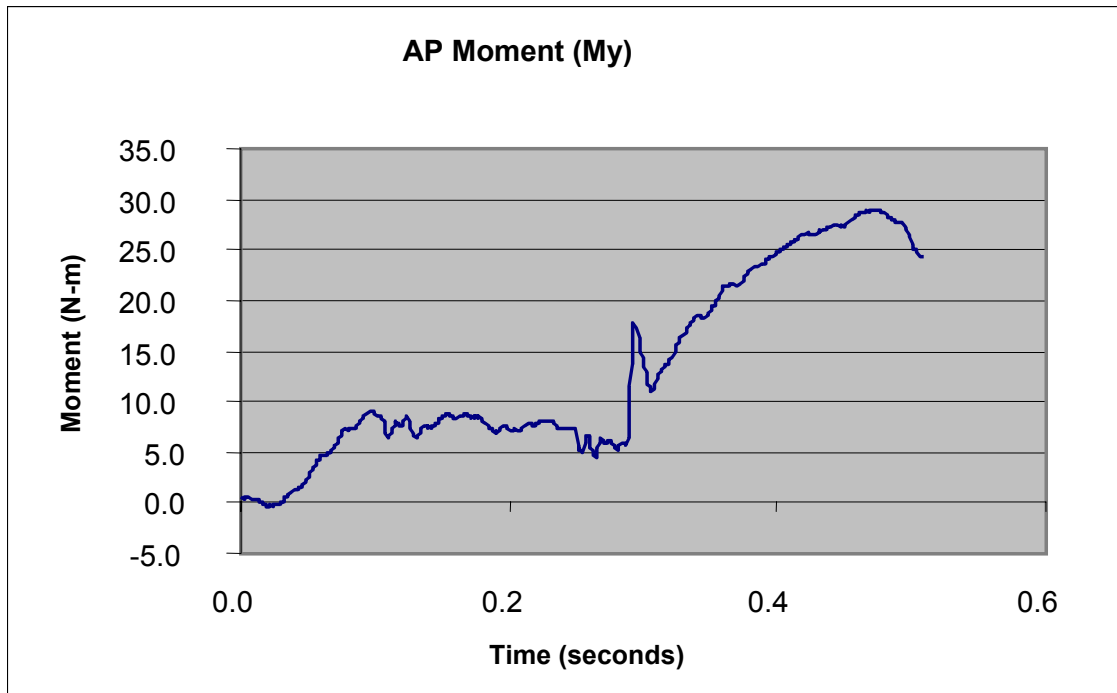


B04F34FAIL.2

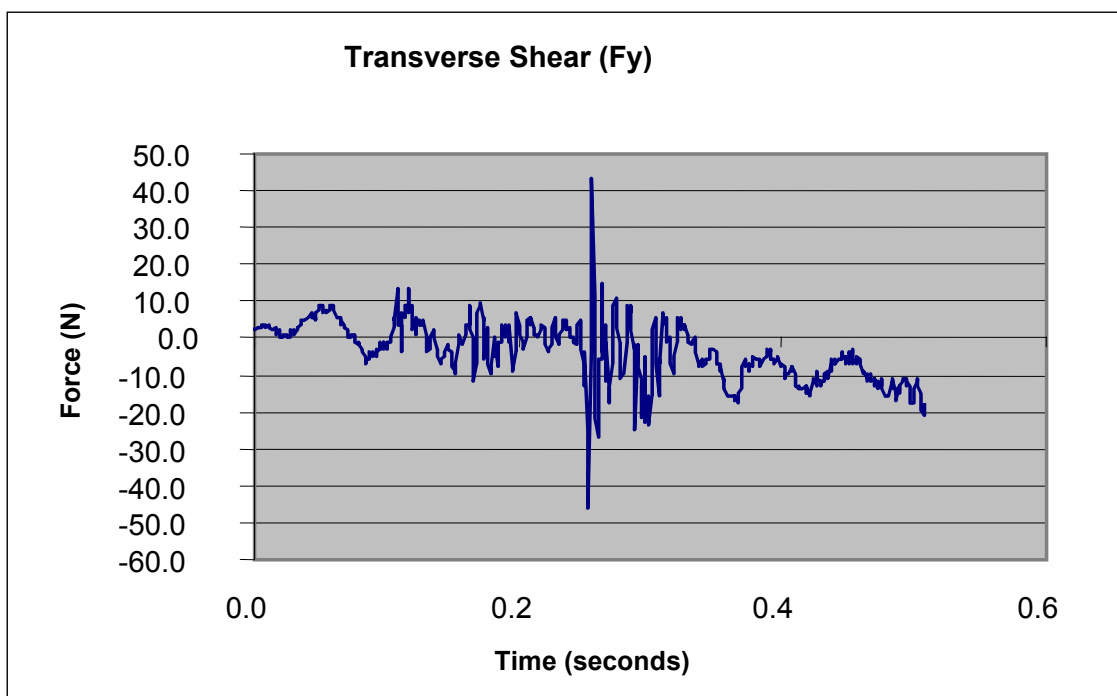


Raw Instrument Data (cont.)

B04F34FAIL.3

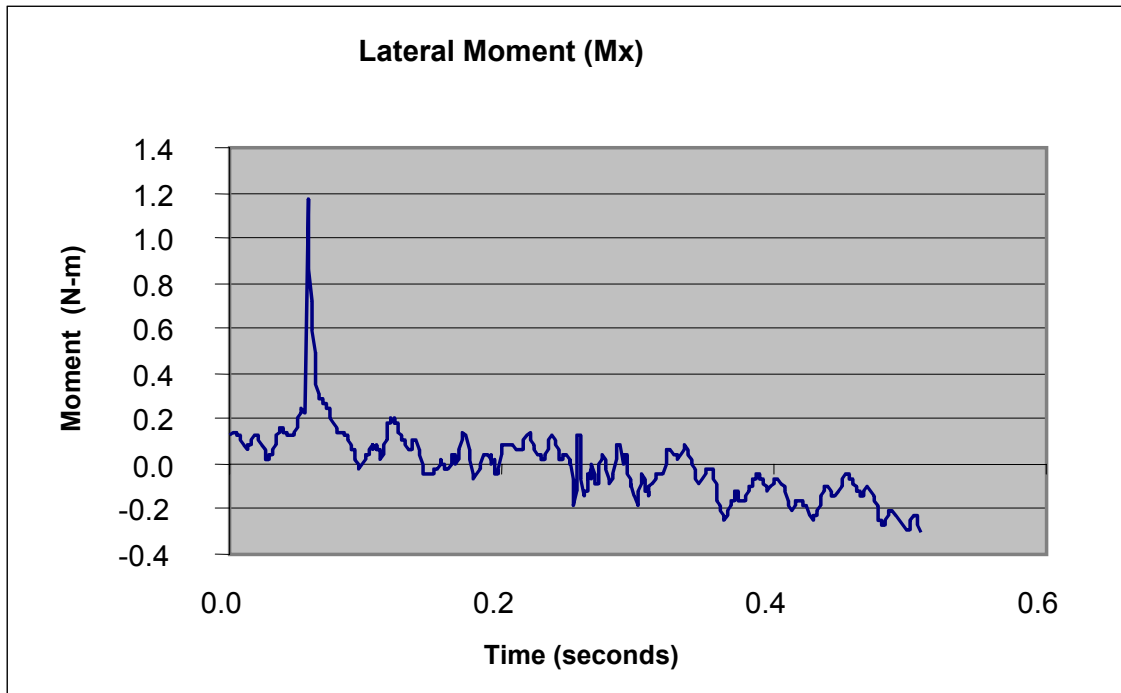


B04F34FAIL.4



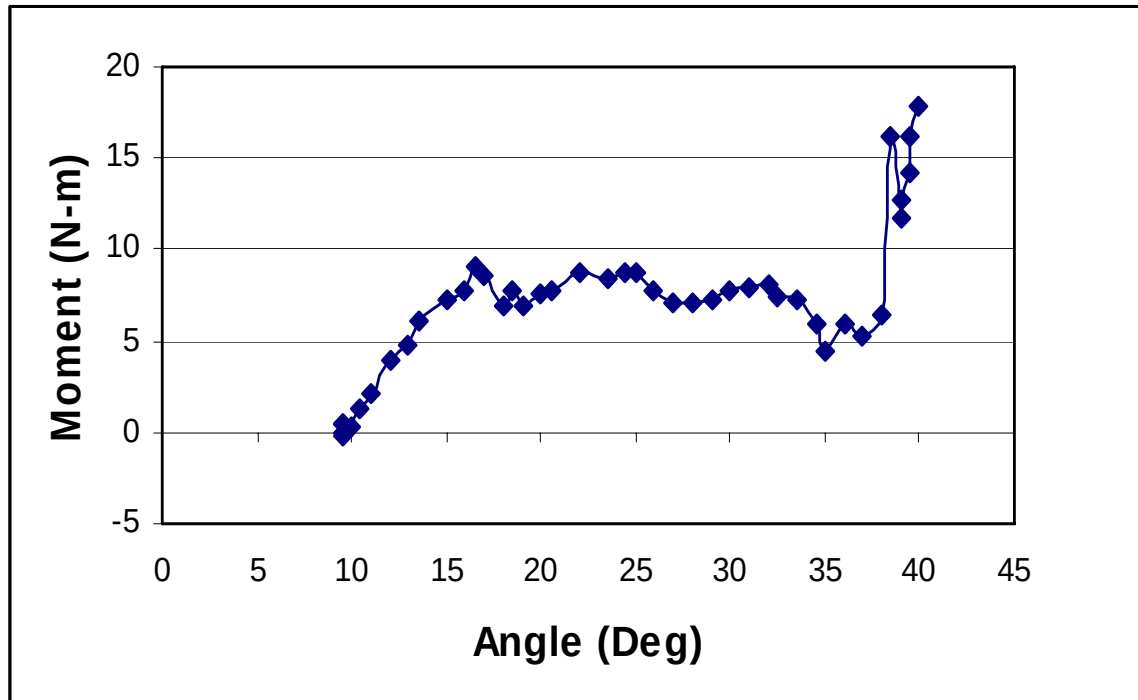
Raw Instrument Data (cont.)

B04F34FAIL.5



Computed Data

B04F34FAIL.6



APPENDIX:

Methods

Unembalmed human heads with intact spines were obtained shortly after death. All specimen handling was performed in compliance with both NHTSA 700-4 guidelines and CDC guidelines. The specimens were sealed in plastic bags, frozen and stored at -20° . All donor medical records were examined to ensure that there were no pre-existing pathologies, such as severe degenerative diseases or spinal pathologies, which could affect the structural responses of the specimens.

The muscular tissues were removed while keeping all the ligamentous structures intact. The lower cervical motion segments (C3-C4, C5-C6, C7-T1) were isolated, cleaned, and cast into aluminum cups with fiber-reinforced polyester resin. The cephalad end of the upper cervical spine specimens was secured using halo fixation. If necessary, the mandible and maxilla were removed in order to allow appropriate flexion range of motion. Upper cervical specimens (Head-C2) were inverted and mounted in the test frame using halo fixation of the head and casting of the C2 vertebra.

The test apparatus applies pure bending moments, and the resulting angular displacements are computed by tracking markers on digital images. The moments are generated using a pair of pneumatic pistons to apply a force-couple. After the specimen was mounted in the test frame, a counterweight was applied to the upper casting assembly. The mass of the counterweight was chosen to counterbalance the mass of the assembly, and to place the motion segment in 0.5 Newtons of tension. The purpose of the 0.5 N tensile load was to establish an initial position for the motion segment in the middle of its neutral zone. The specimen was imaged in this position and the load cell values were zeroed. This image served as the reference position for the flexibility and the failure tests. Prior to flexibility testing, the specimens were preconditioned with 30 cycles of ± 1.5 N-m of moment. The specimens were then loaded with pure flexion and extension moments in 0.5 N-m increments. Thirty seconds of creep were allowed prior to data acquisition, and the load was released between load steps. The peak applied moment was approximately 3.5 N-m. A six-axis load cell (GSE model 6607-00) at the base of the specimen was used to ensure that the moment remained pure. The load cell is also the source of the moment data.

After completion of the above bending tests, the tension mass was removed, and the specimens were failed in either flexion or extension. The loading rate was the maximum that could be achieved using our 100 psi system. The rates were dependent on the stiffness of the specimen, and were on the order of 90 N-m/second. The failure tests were imaged at 125 frames/second. Failure was defined as a decrease in the measured moment with increasing rotation, and they were verified by examination of the high speed images. Specimen dissection was performed to document injuries.

All the image data was uploaded to an SGI running a modified version of the xv shareware package. This software enables us to digitize the location of the marker pins in each image. The location of each marker is determined using a centroid algorithm to increase accuracy. Angular displacements for each image are determined with respect to the reference image.